

KAREN TINOCO

Curriculum Vitae

Washington State University (WSU), Pullman, Washington

B.S. in Mechanical Engineering

June 2028

Minor in Computer Science

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Undergraduate Research Assistant

WSU Department of Mechanical Engineering, Pullman, Washington

Sep. 2025–present

Autonomous Microrobotic Systems Lab led by Dr. Nestor Pérez

- Assisted in designing and manufacturing a butterfly-inspired microrobot
 - Contributed to research meetings.
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CONFERENCES & PRESENTATIONS

Tinoco, K. (2026, March). Design & Fabrication of Butterfly-Inspired Microrobot. *Oral Presentation at the 27th Annual University of Maryland National McNair Scholars and Undergraduate Research Conference, Maryland, WA.*

Tinoco, K. (2026). Design & Fabrication of Butterfly-Inspired Microrobot. *Poster Presentation at the showcase for Undergraduate Research, Pullman, WA.*

Tinoco, K. (2026). Design & Fabrication of Butterfly-Inspired Microrobot. *Oral Presentation at the Gabriel E. Gallardo Research, Student Leadership & Advocacy Symposium, Seattle, WA.*

HONORS & AFFILIATION

WSU Ronald E. McNair Scholars Program

McNair Scholar

April 2025–present

- Conduct independent research with faculty mentor, Dr. Nestor Pérez.
 - Attend and present research at conferences while engaging in scholarly discussions with researchers and peers.
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STUDENT INVOLVEMENT

Society of Hispanic Professionals in Engineering

WSU, Pullman, Washington

Vice President

April 2026–present

- Lead a student organization dedicated to advocacy, cultural education, and community building for Hispanics in STEM.

- Coordinated meetings, campus-wide events, and collaborations with university partners and cultural organizations
- Strengthened leadership, public speaking, teamwork, and organizational skills relevant to community engagement outreach and academic collaboration.

Marketing

Jan. 2026–April 2026

- Developed club events to bring in new members.
- Develop and deliver public-facing presentations and facilitate discussions that strengthen student engagement.

Crimson Robotics

WSU, Pullman, Washington

Design Engineer

Aug. 2025–present

- Contributed in a five-person team in CAD design for teams battle bot.
- Member of manufacturing sub-team, experience with Tormach 110 CNC Milling Machine.

AWARDS

Girls Who Code X AWS Generative AI GameDay

WSU, Pullman, Washington

Nov. 2025